Safe route · Vocabulary and grammar

All the vocabulary and grammar of the Learning Paths on the Safe route, with the explanations as they appear on the site.

How to study it

First all the vocabulary, then all the grammar, Learning Path by Learning Path. Learning Path 4 has no new vocabulary or grammar.

Vocabulary: cover the Catalan column and say what each word means; then read the example aloud.

Grammar: read how it works, cover the answer column and complete the sentences; then check and read why.

1 · Vocabulary

Learning Path 1 · Getting started

Word or expression	In Catalan	Example
Seasons & weather · 16		
spring	primavera	*Flowers grow in spring.*
summer	estiu	*It's hot in summer.*
autumn (UK) / fall (US)	tardor	*Autumn is my favourite season.*
winter	hivern	*It's cold in winter.*
sunny	assolellat	*It's sunny today.*
cloudy	ennuvolat	*It's cloudy and grey.*
windy	ventós	*It's windy by the sea.*
rainy	plujós	*Take an umbrella: it's rainy.*
foggy	amb boira	*It's foggy in the morning.*
cold	fred	*It's very cold in January.*
cool	fresc	*The mornings are cool.*
mild	suau, temperat	*Autumn here is mild.*
warm	càlid, calent	*It's warm in the afternoon.*
the days get shorter / longer	els dies s'escurcen / s'allarguen	*In autumn the days get shorter.*
leaves change colour	les fulles canvien de color	*In October the leaves change colour.*
leaves fall	les fulles cauen	*Leaves fall in November.*
Seasonal food & nature · 11		
chestnuts	castanyes	*We roast chestnuts.*
sweet potatoes	moniatos	*Sweet potatoes are delicious.*
pumpkins	carbasses	*People carve pumpkins at Halloween.*
mushrooms	bolets	*We pick mushrooms in the forest.*
apples	pomes	*Apples are an autumn fruit.*
oranges	taronges	*Oranges are a winter fruit.*
nuts	fruits secs	*Panellets have nuts.*
harvest	collita	*The harvest is in autumn.*

Word or expression	In Catalan	Example
trees	arbres	*The trees lose their leaves.*
plants	plantes	*Plants grow in spring.*
flowers	flors	*There are flowers in spring.*
Feelings · 6		
excited	il·lusionat/da	*I'm excited about the party.*
happy	content/a	*I'm happy at Christmas.*
grateful	agraït/da	*I'm grateful for my family.*
proud	orgullós/osa	*I'm proud of our tradition.*
scared	espantat/da	*I'm scared of ghosts!*
relaxed	relaxat/da	*I feel relaxed at home.*
Seasons & nature (Safe) · 8		
seasonal	de temporada	*Chestnuts are seasonal food.*
crop	collita, conreu	*Rice is an important crop.*
pick fruit	collir fruita	*We pick fruit in September.*
frost	gebre, glaçada	*There's frost on the car.*
chilly	fresquet, fred	*It's chilly: wear a jumper.*
cosy	acollidor	*Our living room is cosy.*
it gets dark early	es fa fosc aviat	*In winter it gets dark early.*
the clocks go back	es retarda el rellotge	*The clocks go back in October.*

Learning Path 2 · Celebrations around the world

Celebration vocabulary

Word or expression	In Catalan	Example
Celebrations · 18		
celebration	celebració	*It's a family celebration.*
festival	festival, festa	*Diwali is a festival of lights.*
holiday	festiu, vacances	*Christmas is a holiday.*
tradition	tradició	*It's an old tradition.*
custom	costum	*Eating grapes is a New Year custom.*
party	festa	*We have a party at home.*
parade	desfilada	*There's a parade in the street.*
fireworks	focs artificials	*We watch the fireworks.*
lights	llums	*The streets are full of lights.*
candles	espelmes	*We light candles.*
decorations	decoració	*We put up decorations.*
present / gift	regal	*I get a present.*
costume	disfressa	*She wears a witch costume.*
mask	màscara	*He wears a mask.*
card	postal, targeta	*I send a card to my aunt.*
special meal	àpat especial	*We have a special meal.*

Word or expression	In Catalan	Example
guests	convidats	*We have ten guests.*
relatives	familiars, parents	*We visit our relatives.*
Celebration verbs · 11		
celebrate	celebrar	*We celebrate it every year.*
decorate	decorar	*We decorate the house.*
dress up	disfressar-se, mudar-se	*Children dress up.*
give / get presents	fer / rebre regals	*We give presents at Christmas.*
sing	cantar	*We sing songs.*
dance	ballar	*People dance in the square.*
cook	cuinar	*My dad cooks a special meal.*
eat together	menjar junts	*The family eats together.*
visit relatives	visitar familiars	*We visit relatives in Girona.*
light candles	encendre espelmes	*They light candles every night.*
wear special clothes	portar roba especial	*People wear special clothes.*
Traditions (Safe) · 10		
gather	reunir-se	*People gather in the square.*
get together	reunir-se, trobar-se	*Families get together.*
take part in	participar en	*I take part in the parade.*
look forward to	tenir ganes de	*I look forward to the holidays.*
pass down	transmetre (de generació en generació)	*Recipes are passed down.*
mark an occasion	commemorar una ocasió	*Fireworks mark the occasion.*
share a meal	compartir un àpat	*We share a meal.*
exchange gifts	intercanviar regals	*Families exchange gifts.*
make a wish	demanar un desig	*Make a wish!*
wish someone a happy…	desitjar un feliç… a algú	*We wish everyone a happy new year.*
Adjectives (Safe) · 10		
meaningful	significatiu	*It's a meaningful day.*
traditional	tradicional	*A traditional dance.*
religious	religiós	*A religious festival.*
secular	laic, no religiós	*A secular holiday.*
local	local	*A local festival.*
worldwide	mundial	*It's celebrated worldwide.*
family-friendly	per a tota la família	*A family-friendly event.*
colourful	colorit	*Colourful decorations.*
crowded	ple de gent	*The streets are crowded.*
festive	festiu	*A festive atmosphere.*

Review from earlier Learning Paths: the days get shorter · chestnuts · mild · harvest · the clocks go back · cosy

Words you will hear or read (no need to learn them): menorah · diyas (oil lamps) · lanterns · reunion dinner · Advent calendar · Caga Tió

Learning Path 3 · Where traditions come from

Dates, comparing and change

Word or expression	In Catalan	Example
Dates & time · 9		
on 31 October	el 31 d'octubre	*The Castanyada is on 31 October.*
in November	al novembre	*Thanksgiving is in November.*
at Christmas	per Nadal	*We get together at Christmas.*
at night	a la nit	*The fireworks are at night.*
every year	cada any	*We celebrate it every year.*
once a year	un cop l'any	*It happens once a year.*
the night before	la nit abans	*We decorate the night before.*
the first	el primer (dia 1)	*on the first of November*
the twenty-fifth	el vint-i-cinc	*on the twenty-fifth of December*
Comparing cultures (Safe) · 6		
both… and…	tant… com…	*Both Diwali and Hanukkah use lights.*
similar to	semblant a	*It's similar to a harvest festival.*
different from	diferent de	*It's different from Christmas.*
whereas	mentre que	*Halloween is about costumes, whereas the Castanyada is about family.*
in the same way	de la mateixa manera	*In the same way, we eat together.*
unlike	a diferència de	*Unlike Hanukkah, Diwali lasts five days.*
Places & travel (Safe) · 5		
travel home for the holidays	tornar a casa per les festes	*Many people travel home for the holidays.*
the town square	la plaça del poble	*The parade ends in the town square.*
the community centre	el centre cívic	*There's a party at the community centre.*
the school hall	la sala d'actes de l'escola	*The event is in the school hall.*
crowded streets	carrers plens de gent	*At Christmas there are crowded streets.*

Review from earlier Learning Paths: celebrate · relatives · parade · dress up · get together · secular

Words you will hear or read (no need to learn them): pilgrims · feast · harvest festival

Learning Path 5 · Plan the day

Planning an event

Word or expression	In Catalan	Example
Plans · 5		
go to a festival	anar a un festival	*We're going to go to a festival.*
meet friends	quedar amb amics	*I'll meet friends in the square.*
book a room	reservar una sala	*We need to book a room.*
buy tickets	comprar entrades	*Can you buy tickets?*
invite people	convidar gent	*We're going to invite people.*
Event planning (Safe) · 9		
organise	organitzar	*We're organising a celebration day.*

Word or expression	In Catalan	Example
set up	muntar, preparar	*We set up the chairs at 9.*
put up posters / decorations	penjar cartells / decoració	*Let's put up posters.*
send invitations	enviar invitacions	*We're sending invitations on Wednesday.*
make a timetable	fer un horari	*We need to make a timetable.*
run a stall / workshop	portar una parada / un taller	*Our class runs a food stall.*
take place	tenir lloc	*It takes place in the hall.*
be held	celebrar-se, fer-se	*The event will be held on Friday.*
book a band / a room	contractar un grup / reservar una sala	*We booked a band.*

Review from earlier Learning Paths: once a year · decorate · guests · the school hall · family-friendly

Learning Path 6 · Write to the head teacher

Formal email language

Word or expression	In Catalan	Example
Email chunks · 4		
Dear...	Benvolgut/da...	*Dear Ms Puig,*
I am writing to...	Us escric per...	*I am writing to propose a celebration day.*
We would like to...	Ens agradaria...	*We would like to organise an event.*
Yours sincerely	Atentament	*Yours sincerely, Omar*
Formal email (Safe) · 7		
Dear Mr / Ms...	Benvolgut Sr. / Benvolguda Sra. ...	*Dear Mr Roca,*
I am writing to propose...	Us escric per proposar...	*I am writing to propose an event.*
Our plan includes...	El nostre pla inclou...	*Our plan includes four stalls.*
Could we use...?	Podríem fer servir...?	*Could we use the hall?*
Please let us know if...	Si us plau, feu-nos saber si...	*Please let us know if you need more information.*
I look forward to hearing from you	Espero la vostra resposta	*I look forward to hearing from you.*
Kind regards	Salutacions cordials	*Kind regards, Laia*

Review from earlier Learning Paths: invite people · book a room · set up · run a stall

Formal or informal? The email to the head teacher

In the email to the head teacher we use the formal version.

Informal (no)	Formal (yes)
Hi!	**Dear Ms Puig,**
I want to do a party.	**We would like to organise a celebration day.**
Can we have the hall?	**Could we use the school hall?**
Write back soon!	**I look forward to hearing from you.**
Bye!	**Yours sincerely,**
Tell us if you need more stuff.	**Please let us know if you need more information.** *(Safe)*

2 · Grammar

Learning Path 1 has no new grammar (it reviews LS1), and Learning Path 4 practises researching and crediting sources.

Learning Path 2 · Celebrations around the world

Present Simple for customs · on / in / at

How it works

- We use the **Present Simple** for customs that happen every year: *People decorate their houses. Children dress up. We don't work on 25 December.*
- Useful chunks: *It is celebrated on… · It takes place in… · It is held in…*
- **on** + date or day (*on 31 October, on New Year's Eve*) · **in** + month or season (*in November, in winter*) · **at** + festival time or night (*at Christmas, at night*).

Practice from the Learning Path, with answers

Sentence	Answer	Why
Children ___ (dress) up at Halloween.	**dress**	Children is plural: no -s.
My grandmother ___ (cook) a special meal every year.	**cooks**	She → verb + -s.
We ___ (not / go) to school on 25 December.	**don't go / do not go**	Negative with we: don't + verb.
The Castanyada is held ___ 31 October.	**on**	A date → on.
Diwali takes place ___ autumn.	**in**	A season → in.
We visit our relatives ___ Christmas.	**at**	A festival period → at.
People light candles ___ night.	**at**	at night.
Lunar New Year ___ celebrated in late January or February.	**is**	It is celebrated…
___ your family decorate the house? — Yes, it does.	**does**	Question with your family (it): Does…?
Hanukkah ___ (last) eight nights.	**lasts**	It → verb + -s.
Families ___ (exchange) gifts at Diwali.	**exchange**	Families is plural: no -s.
Lunar New Year ___ place in late January or February.	**takes**	It takes place…

Learning Path 3 · Where traditions come from

Origins, relatives and comparing

How it works

- **Connectors:** First, Then, Finally; and, also, but, because.
- **Past Simple** for one finished event (*It started in 1621. Lincoln made it official in 1863.*) · **used to** for past habits that are not true now (*People used to carve turnips.*). Negative: *didn't use to*. Question: *Did… use to…?* *(Safe)*
- **Defining relatives:** a festival *which / that…*, people *who…*, a place *where…*, the day *when…* · **Comparing:** both… and, whereas, while, similar to, different from, unlike. *(Safe)*

Practice from the Learning Path, with answers

Sentence	Answer	Why
I love Halloween ___ I can dress up.	**because**	It gives a reason.
My brother likes costumes, ___ he doesn't like scary films.	**but**	Contrast.
___, we clean the house. Then we decorate it.	**first**	First step.
We eat chestnuts. We ___ eat panellets.	**also**	Adds information.
___, we all eat together.	**finally**	Last step.
It's cold outside, ___ the house is cosy.	**but**	Contrast.

Sentence	Answer	Why
The first Thanksgiving ___ (take) place in 1621.	**took**	One finished event: Past Simple.
People in Ireland ___ ___ carve turnips, but now they carve pumpkins.	**used to**	A past habit that is not true now.
Lincoln ___ (make) Thanksgiving official in 1863.	**made**	Irregular Past Simple.
Children ___ (not / use to) go trick or treating in Catalonia.	**didn't use to / did not use to**	Negative: didn't use to (no -d).
___ people use to wear masks at Samhain? — Yes, they did.	**did**	Question: Did… use to…?
Diwali is a festival ___ celebrates light.	**which / that**	Things: which / that.
The Wampanoag were the people ___ lived in the area.	**who / that**	People: who.
The town square is the place ___ the parade ends.	**where**	Places: where.
31 October is the day ___ we eat panellets.	**when**	Time: when.
Halloween is about costumes, ___ the Castanyada is about food and family.	**whereas / while**	Contrast between two things.
___ Hanukkah, Diwali lasts five days.	**unlike**	Unlike + noun.

Learning Path 5 · Plan the day

Future forms

How it works

- **going to** for plans you already have (*We're going to decorate the hall.*) · **will** for decisions made now and offers (*I'll bring the music.*) · **There will be** + noun (*There will be music and food.*).
- **Present Continuous** for arrangements (*We're meeting the head teacher on Monday.*) · **Present Simple** for timetables (*The event starts at 10.00.*) · **will** for predictions (*I think everyone will love it.*). *(Safe)*

Practice from the Learning Path, with answers

Sentence	Answer	Why
We ___ ___ ___ (decorate) the hall. It's our plan.	**are going to decorate / 're going to decorate**	A plan → going to.
"We need music!" "I ___ bring my speaker!"	**will / 'll**	Offer → will.
___ ___ ___ music and food.	**there will be**	There will be + noun.
Ana ___ ___ ___ (make) the posters. She bought the paper yesterday.	**is going to make / 's going to make**	Already planned → going to.
"It's cold in here." "I ___ close the window."	**will / 'll**	Decision now → will.
We ___ ___ ___ (not / invite) other schools.	**aren't going to invite / are not going to invite**	Negative: aren't going to.
___ you going to come?	**are**	Question: Are you going to…?
There ___ ___ four stalls.	**will be**	There will be.
We ___ ___ (meet) the head teacher on Monday at 9. It's in her diary.	**are meeting / 're meeting**	Arrangement → Present Continuous.
The event ___ (start) at 10.00.	**starts**	Timetable → Present Simple.
I think everyone ___ ___ (love) it.	**will love / 'll love**	Prediction → will.
The bus ___ (leave) at 8.15 tomorrow.	**leaves**	Timetable → Present Simple.
We ___ ___ (perform) a dance at 12. We booked the hall yesterday.	**are performing / 're performing**	Arrangement → Present Continuous.

Learning Path 6 · Write to the head teacher

Polite requests

How it works

- **would like to** + verb: *We would like to organise…*
- Polite requests: *Could we…? · Would it be possible to…? (Safe)*

Practice from the Learning Path, with answers

Sentence	Answer	Why
We would like ___ ___ (invite) families.	**to invite**	would like + to + verb.
I would like ___ ___ (explain) our idea.	**to explain**	would like + to + verb.
We would ___ to use the hall.	**like**	would like to.
___ it be possible to start at 10.00?	**would**	Would it be possible to…?
___ we put up posters in the corridor?	**could**	Could we…?